



EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Finger Prints in India 2022, is the 26th annual publication in the series, which highlights the progress and achievements of Central Finger Print Bureau (CFPB) and State Finger Print Bureaux (SFPBx) including the activities, initiatives undertaken, database status, trainings etc., during the calendar year 2022. This publication also presents other useful information such as relevant laws, equipments and relevant books, enabling the readers to equip themselves with the latest developments in the field.

Chapter I - ACTIVITIES OF CENTRAL FINGER PRINT BUREAU (CFPB)

In the calendar year 2022, a total of 547 new document cases were received from different Government agencies like CRPF, Post Offices, Staff Selection Commission, Banks, Railway Recruitment Boards etc. Along with 246 cases pending from previous year, a total of 793 cases were available for examination. Finger Print Experts at CFPB had examined and furnished their expert opinion in 779 cases during the year 2022.

NCRB has conceptualized and implemented National Automated Fingerprint Identification system (NAFIS) which is robust, secure and proving to be a game changer in the field of Finger Print identification & enables the States/UTs/Law Enforcement agencies to upload/trace/retrieve criminal fingerprint data in real time on a 24X7 basis on the server placed in the NCRB. Central Finger Print Bureau (CFPB) has imparted training to the Finger Print experts of States/UTs for using the application. Subsequently, a large number of latent fingerprints-hitherto untraced-received from SFPBx during past years had been processed by Finger Print experts of CFPB and SFPBx/ UTs through NAFIS. Currently, the NAFIS has been commissioned at 1,381 locations covering all Districts, Police Commissionerates, State Finger Print Bureaux and Central LEAs like NIA, CBI and NCB with approximately 1 crore fingerprint records and 500 users concurrency.

XXIII (23rd) All India Conference of Directors of Finger Print Bureaux was organized on 20th and 21st September 2022 at National Crime Records Bureau (NCRB), New Delhi. Delegates from various Finger Print Bureaux, CFSL-DFSS, NIA, FSLs, students from various Colleges and Universities offering Forensic Science and Criminology course participated in the conference. All India Board Examination (AIBE) for Finger Print Experts 2022 was held from 8th to 10th November, 2022.



Chapter II - ACTIVITIES OF STATE FINGER PRINT BUREAUX

Important cases solved by the Finger Print Experts of State Finger Print Bureaux are highlighted in this chapter. After examination, States/UTs had submitted 82 cases however only 71 cases are selected for publication based on the sensitivity, value of property lost/recovered, detection of a series of cases etc.

Main responsibility of a Finger Print expert is to develop chance prints left by criminals at the crime scene and to match these with the fingerprints of the criminals. Further, Finger Print experts also receive fingerprint slips of arrested persons for providing the criminal records by comparing fingerprints database. In the year 2022, Finger Prints Units of the SFPBx/Police/Other Staffs have visited 63,871 crime scenes and they have developed chance prints in 23,931 cases and a total of 67,545 chance prints were found fit for comparison. A total of 3,489 cases have been solved through chance prints.

Chapter III - TRANSACTIONAL ACTIVITIES OF CFPB AND SFPBx

As on 31.12.2022, States/UTs have ten fingerprints database of 99,98,587 convicted and arrested persons. During 2022, CFPB had examined 14 chance prints cases in which 8 chance prints were traced and in 88 cases final opinion also recorded in case of difference in opinion by the State experts.

A total number of 1,773 document cases were received and 1,764 cases were examined by Finger Print experts, 703 cases were pending in the SFPBx. In 214 cases, Finger Print experts from various SFPBx deposed in the Courts of Law for testimonies. Following table shows the All India Statistics of the fingerprint transactions in States/UTs during 2022.

Transactional Activities of State Finger Print Bureaux				
Convict Slips Received	Arrestee Slips Received	FP Document Cases Received	Chance Print Developed (Fit for comparison)	Chance Print Cases Traced/Identified
83,382	12,22,510	1,773	67,545	3,489

Chapter IV - ANALYSIS OF FP TRANSACTIONAL ACTIVITIES

This chapter deals with the analysis of concomitant factors such as conviction rate, reasons of discrepancies in the data provided and inter-comparison of data procured from the State Finger



Print Bureaux along with the depiction of major activities such as record slips, search slips, document cases, chance prints and also categorization of crimes under various heads at a glance.

State of Madhya Pradesh has highest number of fingerprint slips recorded in the year 2022 for conviction of criminals for grievous hurt, murder, rape and assault on women. On an average Punjab, Maharashtra and Uttar Pradesh have recorded significant number of conviction slips. States such as Gujarat, Madhya Pradesh and Maharashtra have recorded the highest number of arrestee slips and several other States including Jharkhand, Delhi, Punjab, Telangana, Tamil Nadu, Odisha, Andhra Pradesh and Haryana have recorded significant number of Finger Print Arrestee slips in proportion to their population and number of crime incidences. Tamil Nadu, Punjab, Rajasthan, Uttar Pradesh, Maharashtra, Andhra Pradesh, Kerala & Karnataka have examined more than 100 document cases in the year 2022. Tamil Nadu, Andhra Pradesh, Karnataka Telangana and Kerala States have topped the list with highest number of chance print cases identified in the year 2022. On further analysis, it was found that record slips of those convicted for murder, grievous hurt, rape, and attempt to murder are the highest in number as compared to other IPC heads whereas the number of search slips recorded also demonstrate a sharp rise for crimes such as grievous hurt, attempt to murder, murder, and kidnaping & abduction. In cases of property related crimes, the number of persons arrested and convicted for the offence of other IPC is higher than those involved in each of theft, burglary, forgery, cheating & fraud and robbery. The number of persons arrested and convicted under NDPS Act come second after other Special and Local Laws (SLL) crimes. States of Madhya Pradesh and Punjab received the highest number of conviction slips.

ANNEXURE:

Useful information like pioneers of Finger Print Science, laws related to fingerprints in India, recommendation of XXIII (23rd) All India FP Directors Conference, staff posted in various Finger Print Bureaux, availability of different types of equipment in each States/UTs, list of AIBE toppers, standard books on Finger Print Science, contact details of State FPBx are covered in the annexures part of this publication.



METHODOLOGY OF DATA COLLECTION AND CONTENT FORMATION

The Bureau brings out its annual report 'Finger Prints in India', which is a collection of statistical data on the performance and activities of States/UTs Finger Print Bureaux, CFPB, and other information related to Finger Prints. The process of publication of the annual report i.e. 'Finger Prints in India' consists of the following steps:

- i) In the 3rd week of January, 2023, a letter was sent to all the Finger Print Bureaux requesting to furnish the information about their activities in the standard Annual Statistics Report (ASR) form. It had the following details:
 - a) Number of convicted persons' fingerprints maintained at the State Finger Print Bureau during the beginning of the year, number of FP slips added in the year under consideration, FP slips received but returned back to police stations due to errors, number of FP slips digitized and entered into NAFIS, number of FP slips eliminated.
 - b) Similar type of information is received in respect of arrested persons.
 - c) Number of FP cases received at Finger Print Bureau seeking previous criminal records, number of cases traced, pendency at Finger Print Bureaux.
 - d) Category of offences for which fingerprints were obtained in the State Finger Print Bureaux.
 - e) Single Digit Section, Scene of Crime details, Documents Section (Govt. and others), Absconder Action/Death Reports.
 - f) NAFIS details regarding its connectivity and functionality status in SFPBx along with availability of FP Live Scanner.
 - g) Details of training courses being organised, its faculty strength and cross-section of officials attending it from police and non-police background.
 - h) Organizational structure of existing FPBx of States/UTs including sanctioned strength, actual strength, vacancies and DFPB as well as source of allotment of funds to them.
 - i) Summary of the milestones achieved by the Bureaux of States/UTs and suggestions for future developments.
 - j) Information in connection with the crime data related to fingerprints by categorizing into various crime heads such as; Murder (Section 302), culpable homicide not amounting to Murder (Section 304), Causing death by Negligence (Section 304-A),



Dowry deaths (Section 304-B), Abetment to suicide (Section 305/306), Attempt to Murder (Section 307) & Culpable Homicide (Section 308), Grievous Hurt (Section 325, 326), Acid Attack (Section 326A, 326B). Assault on Women (Section 354, 354A, B,C,D), Kidnapping & Abduction (Section 363, 363A, 364, 364A, 366A, B & Section 365 to 369) Human Trafficking (Section 370, 370A, 372, 373), Rape (Section 376) etc.

- k) Information on fingerprint (Record and Search) slips about Foreign Nationals committing crime in India and also about Indians involved in crime abroad.
 - l) Information about R&D activities taking place in the SFPBx.
 - m) Chance Print (Scene of Crime) details describing a clear picture of chance print comparison happening in SFPBx and in districts. The table has a column to specify Chance Prints lifted by Finger Print staff, police personnel or other staff.
 - n) Provision is made to furnish judgment details regarding important cases solved by SFPB.
 - o) Information about fingerprint equipments available at state FPB or subordinate offices.
 - p) Information on vehicles available for fingerprint work at state, district and police station levels is also introduced.
- ii) Received information from various units was compared with the previous year information. Observed abnormalities were communicated to the respective unit with a request to validate/rectify.
- iii) Based on the validated data, this publication is prepared.
- iv) In chapter IV, analytical and graphical representations of transactional details of the States have also been presented for ease of comprehension and comparison.
